

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

(This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)

7-0 (A)

Rec'd 2/5/01 wpsl

Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name): WHITE-EYED VIREO		(Scientific Name) <i>Vireo griseus</i>
Date(s) of occurrence: 20 May 2000		
Number of birds seen: One	Sex: Unknown	Plumage: Adult
Exact Location: West side of Crow Valley Campground		
County: Weld	Nearest town: Briggsdale	Elevation: 4900 msl
Length of observation: Approximately 3 minutes	Time(s) of observation: Roughly 9:30 AM MDST	
Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you:		
Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s):		
Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: Overcast		
Optical equipment used: 8x40 Binoculars		
Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): Between 40 and 70 feet		
Was bird(s) photographed? No	If so, have you submitted photos?	
Who took the photographs?		
Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Riparian thicket along stream.		
Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification): Actively foraged in lower half of strata. Bird mostly confined itself to areas within 15 feet of the ground.		
Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):		
The subject bird was a relatively small vireo being slightly larger, stockier, and bigger-headed than a warbler with a thicker, hooked bill. The bird was very active and foraged in the elms between roughly 4 feet to 15 feet above the ground surface. The bill was dark, short, thick, and had a slightly down-drooped culmen. Noticeable were the yellow lores that extended from the upper mandible posteriorly to just beyond the eye suggesting an almost "hook-shaped" aspect. These yellow lores were broader nearer the bill but thinned out to just encircle the eye. These spectacles were separated on the ventral side by dark gray eye-line that extended from the anterior portion of the eye anteriorly to the basal portion of the lower mandible. Quite noticeable was the whitish irids with dark pupils. The crown and mantle were greenish-gray with a gray nape band separating the two parts of the body. The crown was attenuated behind the eye which provided for a more flattened crown than some other members of the Family <i>Vireonidae</i>. This gray band extended towards the throat though the throat was whitish. The wings were short and greenish-gray to greenish black and contained two distinct white wing bars on the coverts. The breast and belly were a whitish-gray and adjoined yellowish flanks which extended from the shoulder of the wing posteriorly to the vent. The tail was greenish-gray and the legs appeared dark.		
Describe bird's call or song: None heard		

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

The combination of very active behavior, short-winged, big-headed, and short, thick, hooked bill were diagnostic towards vireos and separated all warbler species. Separation between other vireos was quite easy. The only vireos with two diagnostic wing bars include Hutton's, Thick, Yellow-throated, Plumbeous, Cassin's, and Blue-headed. Hutton's Vireo's are very small but stockier than a White-eyed with a more bulbous fore-crown. Hutton's are olive-colored, lack the white irides, yellow lores, and yellow flanks, and would be more unusual in northeastern Colorado than White-eyed. Yellow-throated Vireos appear larger (mainly longer) than White-eyed, also lack the combination of white irides and yellow lores, have a bright yellow breast with whitish-gray belly instead of a whitish breast with yellow flanks of a White-eyed, and display grayer wings and mantle than that of a White-eyed. Plumbeous Vireo's, the most expected vireo at this locale, are overall grayish and lack the greenish-yellow basal coloration overall, white irides, and yellow lores of a White-eyed. Cassin's Vireo's, also rare in the spring in Colorado, would also lack the white irides, yellow lores, bright yellow flanks of White-eyed and instead would show a combination of grayish head and mantle (with white spectacles - not yellow), less diagnostic white wing bars, and more extensive whitish breast and belly. Blue-headed Vireo would also be very rare in Colorado, would have a gray head with white lores, and would also lack the white irides.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? Have observed and banded countless birds in the southeastern U.S. Have also observed a few birds in Wisconsin.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None

This report is from notes made during XX or after observation or later from memory

Date of written report: 10/13/00

Reporting observer: Larry Semo

Signature:



Reporting Observer's Address: 9054 Dover Street

City: Westminster

State: Colorado

Zip: 80021

Send report to:
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